KOMTAS

DATA WAREHOUSE

ASSESSMENT

OUR METHODOLOGY

Eleven dimensions placed on evidence, a target state decision, and a dated baseline to measure against

01 **Why it matters**
What an agent or a report can answer depends on the warehouse underneath it. p. 2 – 3

02 **What is assessed**
Eleven dimensions with fixed weights, one maturity ladder, four kinds of evidence. p. 4

03 **How it is assessed**
From evidence to a placed dimension, with or without system access, in five phases. p. 5 – 6

04 **What comes out and next steps**
A target state decision, a sequence and a baseline; what is needed from your side. Appendix from p. 9. p. 7 – 8

Where It Sits — One Question, Four Layers

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An agent's answer is built from the layers below it. This assessment measures the bottom one.

01 · WHERE IT SITS

"What was the average spend of active customers last month?"

"Average net spend was 4,250 TL."
returned with its definition and source table

Action 360
Intelligent Work Experience

Where the question is asked and the answer lands: Teams, Slack, portal, API.

Agent 360
Governed Digital Workforce

Turns the question into a query and acts on the result.

Context 360
Enterprise Context

Says what "active customer" and "net spend" mean: glossary, ontology, semantic layer.

THIS ENGAGEMENT

Data / Analytic 360
Trusted Data Foundation

Holds the numbers: warehouse tables, loads, lineage and access rules.

The answer travels back up — it is only as good as the bottom layer

WHERE A WEAK FOUNDATION SHOWS UP IN THE ANSWER

Two tables define "active customer" differently

The agent returns two different numbers for the same question.

D2 · Modelling and semantics

Last night's load failed and nobody noticed

The answer is a day old and does not say so.

D4 · Ingestion and pipelines

No lineage from the number to its source

The answer cannot be explained or audited.

D5 · Governance and lineage

A sensitive column is not classified

The agent can show it in a chat channel.

D6 · Security and access

The Assessment at a Glance

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What is measured, how the work runs, and what the organisation receives at the end.

11 Dimensions

Weighted before the work starts; the weights do not move with the findings

5 Maturity levels

A level is claimed only where evidence supports it

4 Evidence types

A statement alone is recorded as a claim, never as a finding

6–13 Weeks

Small, medium or large band, set by eleven sizing drivers

HOW IT RUNS · FIVE PHASES IN SEQUENCE



P0 · 1 week

Scoping

Dimensions, target levels and metric definitions agreed in writing



P1 · 2–3 weeks

Evidence collection

Query logs, pipeline history, DDL, walkthroughs and interviews



P2 · 1–2 weeks

Measurement and placement

Metrics computed; each dimension placed on the ladder



P3 · 1–2 weeks

Target state and roadmap

Keep, refactor or replace decided; remediation themes sequenced



P4 · 1 week

Validation and issue

Factual review, report issued, baseline stored

WHAT COMES OUT



Dimension view

Current and target level per dimension



Gap and sequence

Remediation order by weighted gap



Composite score

0–100, for comparison with the next assessment



Target state decision

Keep, refactor or replace

What Is Assessed — Eleven Dimensions on One Ladder

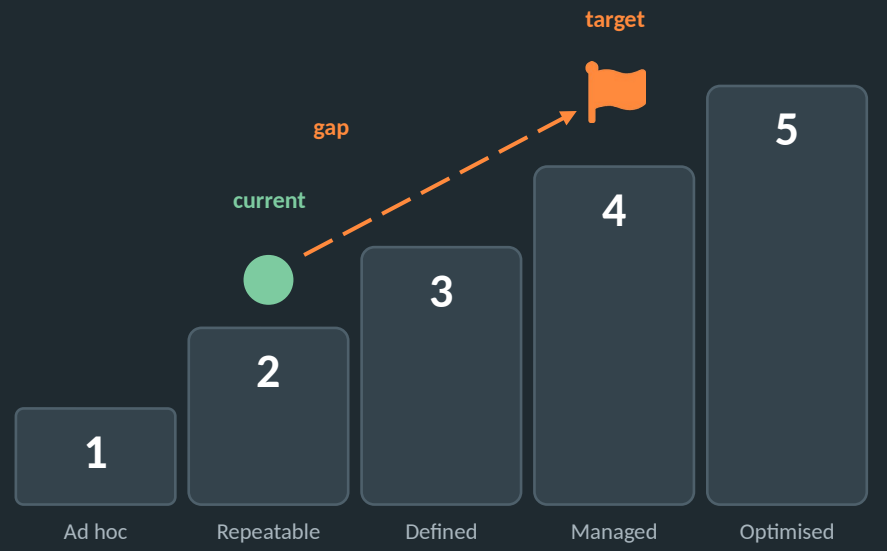
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Each dimension carries a fixed weight and is placed on the same five-level ladder, using evidence of a known type.

02 · WHAT IS ASSESSED



ONE LADDER FOR EVERY DIMENSION



A level is claimed only where evidence supports it. The target is set per dimension; level 5 is not the goal everywhere.

FOUR KINDS OF EVIDENCE

Measurement — places a level

Artefact — places a level

Observation — places a level

Statement — recorded as a claim

How It Is Assessed — From Raw Evidence to a Placed Dimension

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Everything collected is typed before it is used. Only measurement, artefact and observation can place a level.

03 · HOW IT IS ASSESSED

WHAT IS COLLECTED

- Query and workload logs
- Job and scheduler history
- Billing and usage records
- Catalogue and lineage export
- Data model, DDL, job definitions
- Access configuration
- Walkthroughs: a load, a report, a recovery
- Interviews with owners and consumers

EVERY ITEM IS TYPED

Measurement — places a level
A number from the platform over a stated window

Artefact — places a level
A document or configuration that exists on its own

Observation — places a level
Seen working, or failing, in a walkthrough

Statement — recorded as a claim
What a person says

EACH DIMENSION IS PLACED

D4 · Ingestion and pipelines — example

weight 10

1	2	3	4	5
	current		target	

Load success rate over 30 days	measurement
Recovery time after a failure	measurement
Runbook for reloads	artefact
“Failures are rare”	claim only

FIVE PHASES · THE ESTATE AND THE ACCESS SET THE DURATION

P0 Scoping	P1 Evidence	P2 Measurement	P3 Target state	P4 Validation
1 wk	2–3 wks	1–2 wks	1–2 wks	1 wk
metric definitions agreed	access and exports	levels placed	keep, refactor, replace	report and baseline

BAND SETS THE CALENDAR

S	M	L
6 weeks	9 weeks	13 weeks
small estate	mid-sized	large estate

Highest band that at least three sizing drivers fall into. Access approval and log retention move the date.

Two Ways to Run the Assessment

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The method and the report structure stay the same. What changes is who touches the systems and how much of each finding rests on measurement.

03 · HOW IT IS ASSESSED · ACCESS MODEL

Guided assessment

MODE A

No system access for Komtaş

Who touches the systems	Your team only. Komtaş asks, your team answers and shows on screen.
Evidence used	Statements, walkthroughs seen live, documents and exports your team shares.
Measurement	Only where your team runs the agreed checks and shares the output.
What sets the date	Workshop calendar and your team's availability.
Your team's effort	Higher: interviews, walkthroughs, preparing exports.

Each finding is labelled with its evidence type. Levels resting on statements alone are reported as claims, with lower confidence.

or

Evidence-based assessment

MODE B

Read-only access, or exports, for Komtaş

Who touches the systems	Komtaş, read-only, within an agreed window.
Evidence used	Platform measurements, artefacts and walkthroughs, with interviews for context.
Measurement	Query logs, job history, billing and catalogue over a stated window.
What sets the date	Access approval lead time and log retention.
Your team's effort	Lower: access set-up, workshops, fact checking.

Most levels rest on measurement. The result can be repeated with the same definitions as a baseline.

The mode is agreed in P0 and can differ per dimension. A guided assessment can move to evidence-based later; the baseline is then re-taken.

What Comes Out — A Decision, a Sequence and a Baseline

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The result is read as three views, turned into a target state decision, and kept as the baseline for the next assessment.

04 · WHAT COMES OUT

THREE VIEWS OF THE RESULT

Dimension view

Current and target level for each dimension, with the evidence behind it

Gap and sequence

Ordered by weighted gap; dependencies override the raw order

Composite score

0–100, compared only with this organisation's next assessment

TARGET STATE DECISION

Decided in P3 against criteria agreed at scoping. No single criterion decides.

Keep and optimise

The platform is not the constraint; the operating model is.

Refactor in place

The platform is sound, the design on it is not.

Replace or move

The platform cannot serve the workload it now has.

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

you are here

1. **Assessment** 6–9 weeks
   Evidence placed, decision made, baseline dated
2. **Foundations** scoped after the findings
   Ownership, lineage and quality on the critical list
3. **Platform work** scoped after the findings
   Only if the platform itself is the constraint
4. **Re-assessment** 6–12 months after
   Same definitions; movement is measured

WHAT IS HANDED OVER

Assessment report

Findings by dimension, evidence type and gap

Executive summary

The decision, the three findings behind it, the recommendation

Remediation plan

Themes in sequence with dependency, effort band and risk

Target state recommendation

Keep, refactor, replace or hybrid, with rejected options

Evidence pack

Measurements and exports kept as the dated baseline

What We Need From You — and the Next Steps

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Three roles on your side, two constraints that set the date, and four steps from today to the start of the work.

04 · NEXT STEPS

WHO WE NEED ON YOUR SIDE

Sponsor

decision points · P0, P3, P4

Sets the decision the assessment supports, the scope and the target level per dimension. Clears access.

Platform lead

throughout

Grants access or runs the walkthroughs, explains how the platform runs, checks facts before issue.

Data owners

workshops only

Name the critical datasets and their freshness and quality targets.

Business unit representatives join the interviews; information security confirms what may leave the environment.

TWO THINGS THAT SET THE DATE

Access model

Read access or exports for Komtaş — or guided sessions where your team answers and shows the systems on screen.

Agreed in P0; see page 6

Log retention

How many days of query and usage history the platform keeps.

Under 30 days adds an observation window

Neither can be shortened by adding people. Both are asked in the information form.

NEXT STEPS

1. **Methodology walkthrough** — today
   you are here
2. **Short information form** — 11 questions, about one hour
3. **Proposal** — band, schedule, modules
4. **P0 kick-off** — scope, access model, metric definitions

The output is a decision, not a document. Eleven dimensions placed on evidence, a keep / refactor / replace recommendation against agreed criteria, and a dated baseline the next assessment is measured against.

APPENDIX

Method in detail — for reference and questions

A

Scope and reference model

Where the assessment sits · Reference model · Dimensions and weights · Maturity ladder

p. 10 – 13

B

Method and schedule

Evidence model · Assessment process · Roles · Sizing drivers · Estimated schedule

p. 14 – 18

C

Results and limits

Measurements · Target state decision · Reporting · From assessment to delivery · Limits

p. 19 – 23

Where This Assessment Sits — AI Value Proposition

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Four layers. Agents are built in Agent 360 on top of everything below them; a data warehouse assessment is work in the bottom layer, and the condition the three above it depend on.

Action 360

Intelligent Work Experience

Teams | Slack | WhatsApp | Web / Portal | Claude Desktop | API, Headless Interfaces

Agent 360

Governed Digital Workforce

Agents solve a problem in one business line

BY INDUSTRY: Manufacturing | Retail | Banking | Energy | Aviation | Other industries

BY FUNCTION: Customer Services | Sales | Finance | Procurement | Operations | Other agents

Context 360

Enterprise Context

Semantic Layer | Ontology | Knowledge Graph | Master Data | Corporate Memory

Data / Analytic 360

Trusted Data Foundation

THIS ENGAGEMENT · 11 DIMENSIONS

Datawarehouse / Lakehouse | Integration | Data Virtualization | Data Governance / MDM | Lineage | Access Control

Each layer consumes the one below it. The assessment covers the whole bottom layer across eleven dimensions and places each one on evidence.

WHAT THE FOUNDATION DETERMINES ABOVE IT

Context 360

A semantic layer, an ontology and a knowledge graph inherit the warehouse's definitions, lineage and quality. Built on an unassessed foundation, they encode its errors as meaning.

Agent 360

An agent solving a problem in one business line is only as reliable as the data it acts on. Agents turn a data quality problem into an action problem.

Action 360

Delivery through Teams, Slack, a portal or an API multiplies exposure to whatever the foundation gets wrong, across every channel at once.

Data Warehouse Assessment — Reference Model

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What is examined, where it is examined, and what kind of evidence it produces

Platform- and vendor-independent. The model defines what is assessed and what evidence closes it; it does not assume a target product.

1. Sources and Ingestion

- **Source inventory** — systems, owners, volumes
- **Ingestion pattern** — batch, CDC, streaming
- **Load windows** — duration vs. available window
- **Pipeline reliability** — success rate, MTTR
- **Onboarding lead time** — days to add a source

2. Storage and Layering

- **Layer definition** — raw, cleansed, curated
- **Storage footprint** — growth, compression, copies
- **Retention and archive** — policy vs. actual
- **Partitioning and indexing**
- **Duplication across layers** — how many copies exist

3. Modelling and Semantics

- **Modelling approach** — dimensional, vault, flat
- **Historisation** — slowly changing dimensions
- **Semantic layer** — where metrics are defined
- **Naming and standards**
- **Model coverage** — critical entities modelled

4. Serving and Consumption

- **Workload classes** — BI, ad hoc, extract, ML
- **Query latency** — p95 by workload class
- **Concurrency** — peak vs. capacity
- **Certified vs. shadow reports**
- **Self-service enablement**

5. Quality and Reconciliation

- **Reconciliation to source** — break rate vs. source system
- **Quality rules** — coverage and enforcement
- **Reload and exceptions** — rejected record path, repeatability
- **Freshness vs. SLA** — per critical dataset
- **Schema change breakage** — frequency and blast radius
- **Trust signals** — what consumers actually believe

6. Operations

- **Monitoring and alerting**
- **Incident history** — volume and causes
- **Change management** — release and rollback
- **Disaster recovery** — last successful test

7. Governance

- **Ownership** — named owner per dataset
- **Lineage** — end to end coverage
- **Catalogue and metadata**
- **Access and privacy** — classification, reviews

Cross-Cutting Dimensions — assessed across every column

Cost and Efficiency

- Cost per TB stored and scanned
- Idle vs. active compute ratio
- Chargeback and visibility

Security and Privacy

- Classification of sensitive columns
- Access review coverage
- Masking and row-level rules

Performance and Scale

- Headroom against growth
- Elasticity and workload isolation
- Degradation under concurrency

People and Operating Model

- Roles and separation of duties
- Key person dependency
- Skill coverage per platform

AI and ML Readiness

- Feature and training data access
- Unstructured data position
- Reproducibility of a dataset

Evidence and Measurement

- Metric definitions agreed in advance
- Observation window stated
- Three-state evidence scale

NOTES

- The columns are a map of what is examined, not a sequence of work.
- Every item resolves to either a measurement or a stated evidence gap.
- Scope may be narrowed; narrowing is written into the report, never left implicit.

COLOUR LEGEND — ITEM TYPE

- Structure
- Governance
- Measurement
- Cost & Consumption

HOW TO USE THIS MODEL

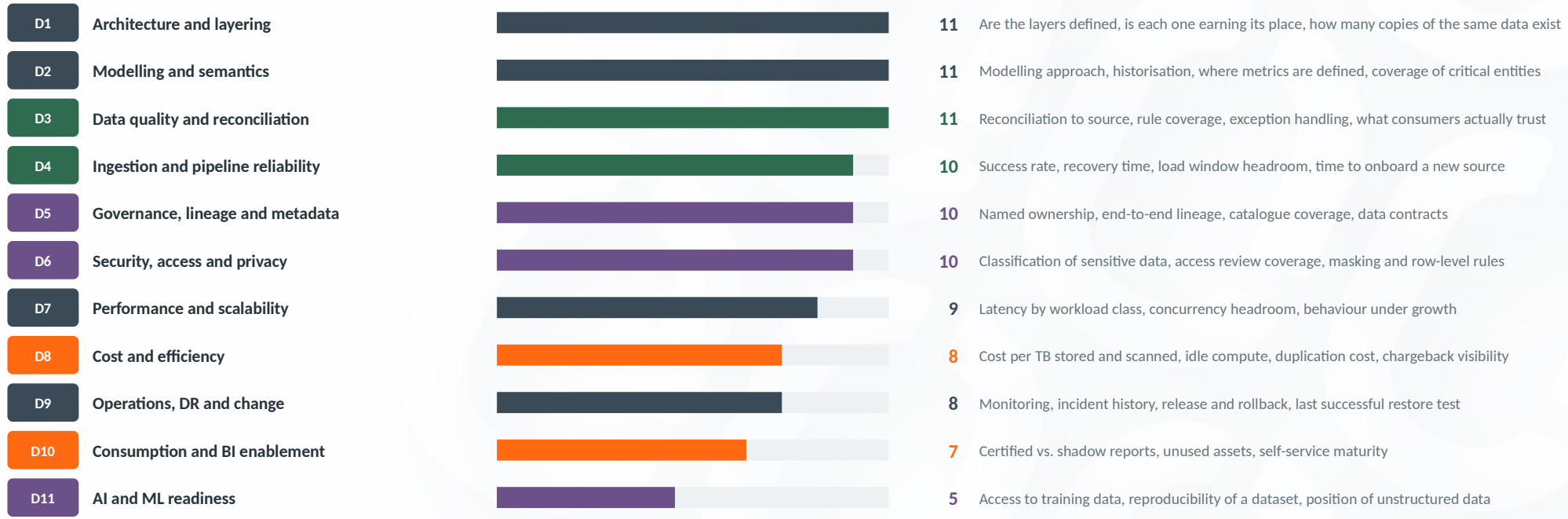
A catalogue of what a full assessment covers. The engagement scope selects from it; what is left out is declared, not dropped.

Assessment Dimensions and Weights

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Eleven dimensions, weights summing to 100. The weights are fixed before the engagement starts and do not change with what the assessment finds.

DIMENSION WEIGHTS



D1	Architecture and layering	11	Are the layers defined, is each one earning its place, how many copies of the same data exist
D2	Modelling and semantics	11	Modelling approach, historisation, where metrics are defined, coverage of critical entities
D3	Data quality and reconciliation	11	Reconciliation to source, rule coverage, exception handling, what consumers actually trust
D4	Ingestion and pipeline reliability	10	Success rate, recovery time, load window headroom, time to onboard a new source
D5	Governance, lineage and metadata	10	Named ownership, end-to-end lineage, catalogue coverage, data contracts
D6	Security, access and privacy	10	Classification of sensitive data, access review coverage, masking and row-level rules
D7	Performance and scalability	9	Latency by workload class, concurrency headroom, behaviour under growth
D8	Cost and efficiency	8	Cost per TB stored and scanned, idle compute, duplication cost, chargeback visibility
D9	Operations, DR and change	8	Monitoring, incident history, release and rollback, last successful restore test
D10	Consumption and BI enablement	7	Certified vs. shadow reports, unused assets, self-service maturity
D11	AI and ML readiness	5	Access to training data, reproducibility of a dataset, position of unstructured data

Why weights at all

Without them, the loudest finding sets the agenda. A weight states before the engagement which dimension carries more consequence for this organisation.

When a weight may change

Only at scoping, with the client, and written into the report. A weight is never adjusted after the findings are known.

What a weight is not

It is not a budget allocation and not a measure of effort. A dimension may score well and still consume most of the remediation cost.

Maturity Ladder — How Each Dimension Is Placed

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Each dimension is placed on the same five-level ladder. A level is claimed only where evidence supports it; without evidence the level below is recorded.

1 · Ad hoc

It works because particular people make it work.

- No written definition of layers or ownership
- Loads are fixed by hand when they fail
- Numbers are reconciled in spreadsheets
- Nobody can say what a dataset costs

2 · Repeatable

The same thing is done the same way, but only by habit.

- Conventions exist in people's heads
- Pipelines rerun but failures are found by users
- Some quality checks, no coverage figure
- Documentation lags behind the platform

3 · Defined

Written down, agreed, and the same across teams.

- Layers, ownership and naming are documented
- Load SLAs stated per critical dataset
- Quality rules versioned with the pipeline
- Lineage exists for the critical path

4 · Managed

Measured against targets and acted on when it drifts.

- Freshness, latency and cost are monitored against targets
- Incidents have causes and closure times
- Access reviews run on a cycle
- Change goes through release and rollback

5 · Optimised

The platform improves itself on evidence, not on opinion.

- Cost and performance tuned against measured workloads
- Unused assets retired on a cycle
- New sources onboarded to a known lead time
- Model and semantics evolve with a contract

A dimension is placed at the highest level for which every statement below it also holds. A platform that monitors cost but has no written ownership is level 2, not level 4 — the ladder is not a menu.

Level 5 is not the target for every dimension. The target level is set per dimension against what the organisation needs; pushing a dimension above its needed level is spend without a return.

Evidence Model — What Closes a Question

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An assessment is worth what its evidence is worth. The evidence type is recorded next to every finding, so the reader can see which conclusions rest on measurement and which rest on a claim.

1. MEASUREMENT

A number produced from the platform itself over a stated window.

- Query log extract
- Pipeline run history
- Storage and compute billing records
- Catalogue and lineage export

2. ARTEFACT

A document or configuration that exists independently of what anyone says.

- Data model and DDL
- Pipeline and job definitions
- Access control configuration
- Runbooks and DR test records

3. OBSERVATION

Something seen working, or failing, in a walkthrough.

- Load executed end to end
- A report traced back to source
- A failed job recovered
- An access request fulfilled

4. STATEMENT

What a person says. Recorded as a claim, never as a finding on its own.

- Interview and workshop notes
- Self-assessment questionnaires
- Vendor and internal roadmaps
- Historical context not in any system

A statement alone never raises a maturity level. “We reconcile every night” is recorded as a claim until a reconciliation run or its output is seen; where it cannot be seen, the report says so rather than resolving it in either direction.

THREE-STATE SCALE — APPLIED PER QUESTION, NOT PER DIMENSION

Evidence provided

A measurement, artefact or observation supports the stated level.

Partial evidence

Part of the evidence exists; the remainder was out of scope or unavailable.

Evidence not produced

The evidence could not be produced in the engagement window. It does not mean the control is absent.

RULES APPLIED TO THE EVIDENCE ITSELF

An absent measurement is a finding

If the platform cannot report its own query latency or load success rate, that is itself a maturity signal and is recorded as one.

The observation window is stated

A two-week window during a quiet period does not describe peak behaviour. The window is written next to every measurement.

Scope reductions stay visible

Anything excluded for access, time or confidentiality reasons is listed. A narrowed scope lowers confidence, it does not raise the score.

Assessment Process

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Five phases, roughly six to nine weeks for a mid-sized estate. The phases are sequential because each one constrains what the next is allowed to claim.

P0 · Scoping

1 week

- Dimensions in scope and target level per dimension
- Critical datasets and workloads named by the client
- Access requests raised and granted
- Metric definitions and observation window agreed in writing

RULE — Nothing is measured until the metric definitions are agreed; otherwise the numbers are argued, not used

P1 · Evidence collection

2 – 3 weeks

- Query logs, pipeline history, billing and catalogue exports
- Data model, DDL, job definitions and access configuration
- Walkthroughs: a load, a report traced to source, a recovery
- Interviews with owners, engineers and consumers

RULE — Each item lands as measurement, artefact, observation or statement — the type is recorded with it

P2 · Measurement and placement

1 – 2 weeks

- Metrics computed over the agreed window
- Each dimension placed on the ladder against the evidence
- Gap between current and target level stated per dimension
- Weighted score computed and the composition shown

RULE — A level without evidence is not claimed; the level below is recorded with the gap stated

P3 · Target state and roadmap

1 – 2 weeks

- Target architecture decision against the criteria
- Findings grouped into remediation themes with sequence
- Effort, dependency and risk per theme
- What is deliberately not being fixed, and why

RULE — Every recommendation traces to a finding; a recommendation with no finding behind it is removed

P4 · Validation and issue

1 week

- Factual review with the platform team
- Disagreements recorded alongside the finding, not resolved away
- Report issued with scope, window and evidence gaps declared
- Baseline stored for the next assessment

RULE — A single assessment is a snapshot; the value appears on the second one

Access is the critical path, not analysis. Where read access to logs, billing and catalogue cannot be granted, the schedule is set from what access is actually available — not from the ideal plan.

An assessment that ends at a score has not finished. The deliverable is a decision: what to keep, what to refactor, what to replace, and in which order.

Capabilities Required — By Role

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The roles the engagement needs, on both sides. A missing role is not absorbed by the others; it becomes a dimension that is assessed on statements rather than evidence.

ROLE	SIDE	WHAT IT CONTRIBUTES	PHASES	INVOLVEMENT
Assessment Lead	Komtaş	Owns the method, the scope and the report. Places dimensions, writes findings, defends them in the readout.	**P0–P4**	Throughout
Data Architect	Komtaş	Assesses architecture, layering, modelling and the target state options. Produces the keep / refactor / replace recommendation.	**P1–P3**	Throughout
Platform / DWH Engineer	Komtaş	Extracts and computes the measurements: query logs, run history, billing, schema. Knows the specific platform in use.	**P1–P2**	Heaviest in P1
Data Governance Consultant	Komtaş	Assesses ownership, lineage, catalogue, contracts and classification. Carries the Context 360 conversation.	**P1–P3**	Part-time
BI / Analytics Consultant	Komtaş	Assesses consumption: certified vs. shadow, usage, semantic definitions, where numbers are rebuilt by hand.	**P1–P2**	Part-time
Security and Privacy Specialist	Komtaş	Assesses classification, access reviews, masking and residency constraints.	**P1**	Short, focused
FinOps / Cost Analyst	Komtaş	Assesses attributable cost, idle capacity and duplication. Often the finding that funds the programme.	**P1–P2**	Short, focused
Client Sponsor	Client	Sets the decision the assessment supports, the scope and the target level per dimension. Clears access.	**P0, P3–P4**	Decision points
Client Platform Lead	Client	Grants access, explains how the platform actually runs, validates facts before issue.	**P0–P1, P4**	Throughout
Client Data Owners	Client	Name the critical datasets, their freshness and quality targets, and confirm what they are accountable for.	**P0–P1**	Workshops only

Minimum viable team

Assessment Lead, Data Architect and Platform Engineer. Below this, the measurement set is too thin to place eleven dimensions on evidence.

Where the gap usually is

Governance and FinOps. Both are treated as optional and both produce the findings that change the sponsor's decision.

Client-side is not optional

Without a platform lead who can grant access and explain how the estate really runs, the engagement becomes interview-based and says so in its confidence rating.

Sizing the Engagement — the Metrics That Set the Schedule

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Eleven drivers, collected in P0 before any commitment on dates. Duration follows the estate and the access, not the ambition of the scope.

SIZING DRIVER	SMALL	MEDIUM	LARGE
Source systems feeding the warehouse	S up to 15	M 16 – 50	L more than 50
Critical datasets in scope	S up to 30	M 31 – 100	L more than 100
Subject areas	S up to 3	M 4 – 8	L more than 8
Distinct warehouse / lake platforms	S one	M two	L three or more
Reports and dashboards in the estate	S up to 300	M 301 – 1,500	L more than 1,500
Environments to be examined	S production only	M production and one other	L three or more
Legal entities or regions in scope	S one	M two or three	L more than three
Access lead time for logs and billing	S granted within a week	M two to three weeks	L longer, or partial only
Regulatory exposure	S none specific	M sector-regulated	L multi-jurisdiction
Log and usage history retention	S 90 days or more	M 30 – 89 days	L under 30 days
Prior assessment baseline	S exists and is usable	M partial	L none

BANDING RULE — the engagement takes the highest band that at least three drivers fall into. A single large driver does not move the band; three do, because they compound.

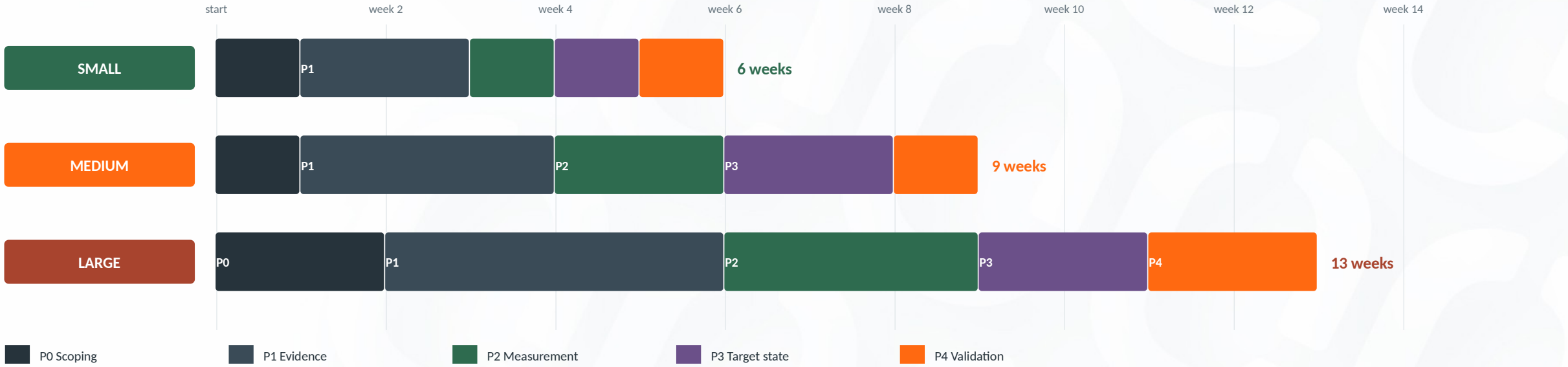
Access lead time and log retention are the two drivers that cannot be compensated for by adding people. Where either lands in the large band, the date moves regardless of team size.

Estimated Schedule

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Indicative durations by band, derived from the sizing drivers. Committed dates are set in the first week, once access lead times are known.

TIMELINE BY BAND



The phases overlap by at most a few days. Measurement cannot begin on a dataset whose evidence is still being collected, and the target state work cannot begin before every dimension has been placed.

WHAT MOVES THE DATE

Access approvals

The dominant driver. Each evidence source is a separate approval; all of them are raised as one list in the first week.

Short log retention

If query and usage history is under 30 days, an instrumentation window is added before evidence collection can produce a usable measurement.

Multiple platforms

Each additional warehouse or lake repeats the extraction and the measurement. It does not repeat the method.

Unavailable data owners

Critical datasets cannot be named by the platform team on the owners' behalf. Workshops are rescheduled, not skipped.

Scope added after week one

A new subject area re-opens the sizing. The band is recalculated and the date is reset with it.

Durations assume read-only exports over an agreed observation window rather than standing access, and a platform lead available throughout evidence collection. The foundations and platform stages that follow the assessment are sized separately, after the findings.

Measurements the Assessment Takes

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The quantitative spine. Each metric is defined and agreed at scoping, computed over a stated window, and reported with the window next to it.

MEASUREMENT	HOW IT IS OBTAINED	WHAT IT TELLS	TYPICAL RED FLAG
PIPELINE AND FRESHNESS			
Load success rate and MTTR	Scheduler / orchestrator run history	Whether the platform recovers itself or people recover it	Recovery measured in people, not minutes
Freshness lag vs. stated SLA	Load completion time per critical dataset	Whether the promise made to consumers is kept	An SLA exists but was never measured
Source onboarding lead time	Date raised to date in production, last 10 sources	Whether adding data is routine or a project each time	Measured in quarters
PERFORMANCE AND CAPACITY			
Query latency p95 by workload class	Query log over the agreed window	Whether the platform serves the work it is actually asked to do	One class starved by another
Concurrency at peak vs. capacity	Query log, concurrency slots or queue depth	Where the ceiling is and how close daily use gets to it	Queueing is normal and nobody reports it
Growth headroom	Load duration vs. window; storage growth vs. capacity	How long the current design survives at current growth	Batch window above 80% used, no plan for growth
QUALITY AND TRUST			
Reconciliation break rate	Comparison of warehouse totals to source totals	Whether the warehouse agrees with the systems it reports on	Breaks are known and tolerated
Quality rule coverage	Rules defined vs. critical datasets	How much of the critical path is actually checked	Rules concentrated where failures are harmless
Schema change breakage	Change history vs. downstream incidents	Whether change is absorbed or propagated as outage	No record of what broke last time
COST AND FOOTPRINT			
Cost per TB stored and scanned	Billing records against workload tags	Where the money goes and whether anyone can see it	Cost not attributable to any team or workload
Idle vs. active compute	Utilisation over the window	How much is paid for capacity nobody used	Always-on clusters serving a daily batch
Copies of the same data	Layer inventory and lineage	How much of the footprint is duplication rather than value	The same table in four places, three unowned
GOVERNANCE AND ACCESS			
Ownership and contract coverage	Catalogue export against critical dataset list	Whether anyone is accountable for a dataset	Critical datasets with no named owner
Lineage completeness	Lineage export vs. critical reports	Whether impact of a change can be assessed before making it	Lineage stops at the warehouse boundary
Access review coverage	Access control configuration and review records	Whether permissions reflect current roles	Last review predates a reorganisation
CONSUMPTION			
Certified vs. shadow reports	BI platform inventory and usage logs	How much of consumption runs outside the governed path	Extracts rebuilt by hand in spreadsheets
Unused assets	Usage logs over 90 days	How much of the estate is maintained for nobody	A third of reports unopened, none retired

Where a measurement cannot be taken — no query log retention, no workload tagging, no usage history — that absence is itself recorded as a finding. A platform that cannot describe its own behaviour cannot be managed against a target.

Target State Decision — Keep, Refactor or Replace

KOMTAS

Decided in P3, after placement, against criteria agreed at scoping. No single criterion decides; the pattern across them does.

CRITERION	POINTS TO KEEP AND OPTIMISE	POINTS TO REFACTOR IN PLACE	POINTS TO REPLACE / LAKEHOUSE
Workload the platform must serve	BI and reporting on modelled data	Mixed BI, exploration and ad hoc SQL	BI plus ML, streaming and semi-structured
Data types in scope	Structured, relational	Mostly structured, some semi-structured	Structured, semi-structured and unstructured
Scale and growth trajectory	Predictable, within current capacity	Growing but bounded	High or unpredictable growth
Concurrency profile	Known peaks, stable user base	Variable, bursty	Heavily variable with isolated workload classes
Cost model requirement	Predictable fixed cost preferred	Mixed, some elasticity needed	Consumption-based, elastic
Engineering capability	SQL and ETL tooling	SQL plus some engineering	Engineering-led, code-first
Governance maturity today	Level 3 or above	Level 2 to 3	Level 3 or above required before the move
Existing investment	Significant, recent, serving its purpose	Significant but constraining	Reaching end of life or end of contract
Regulatory and residency constraints	Satisfied today	Satisfiable with work	Requires explicit verification on the target
Time pressure	No external deadline	Deadline in 12 months or more	Deadline inside 12 months

The default recommendation is to fix the operating model before replacing the platform. Ownership, lineage and quality gaps follow the data onto any new platform and arrive there with migration risk added. Replacement is recommended where the platform itself is the binding constraint.

KEEP AND OPTIMISE

The platform is not the constraint; the operating model is.

REFACTOR IN PLACE

The platform is sound, the design on it is not.

REPLACE OR MOVE TO LAKEHOUSE

The platform cannot serve the workload the organisation now has.

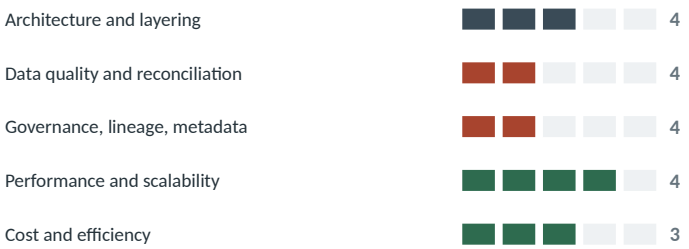
How the Result Is Reported

KOMTAS

Three outputs, read together. The dimension view drives remediation, the gap view drives sequencing, and the composite exists only to show movement between assessments.

1 · DIMENSION VIEW

Each of the eleven dimensions with its current level, target level and the findings behind it.



illustrative — bars show current level, figure shows target

2 · GAP AND SEQUENCE

Dimensions ordered by weighted gap, with dependencies, to produce a remediation sequence.

- Weighted gap = (target − current) × dimension weight
- Dependencies override raw gap order: ownership before lineage, lineage before contracts
- Each theme carries effort, dependency and risk
- What is deliberately not being fixed is listed with it

3 · COMPOSITE SCORE

Weighted sum of the eleven dimension levels, on a 0–100 scale. Reported with its composition, never alone.

Its only legitimate use is comparison with this organisation's own previous assessment.

- Not a benchmark against other organisations
- Not a pass or fail threshold
- Not a substitute for the findings

A composite score is the part of the report that travels furthest and carries the least information. It is reported because it is the only thing that makes two assessments comparable at a glance — and for no other reason.

WHAT IS HANDED OVER

Assessment report

Findings by dimension with evidence type, current and target level, and the gap. The working document.

Executive summary

The decision the assessment was commissioned to support, the three findings that bear on it, and the recommendation.

Remediation plan

Themes in sequence with dependency, effort band and risk, including what is not being addressed and why.

Target state recommendation

Keep, refactor, replace or hybrid — against the stated criteria, with the rejected options and their reasons.

Evidence pack

The measurements, exports and observation records the findings rest on, retained as the dated baseline.

From Assessment to Delivery

KOMTAS

The assessment is the first stage of a sequence, not a standalone exercise. The two stages in the middle are not sized here, because their scope is what the assessment exists to establish.

STAGE 1 · Assessment

6 – 9 weeks

- Evidence collected, measured and placed
- Findings issued with evidence type and gap
- Target state decision made against criteria
- Dated baseline retained

RULE — Output is a decision, not a document

STAGE 2 · Foundations

scoped after the findings

- Ownership assigned on the critical list
- Lineage completed on the critical path
- Quality rules and reconciliation where they are missing
- Cost attribution made visible

RULE — Done before any platform change, whatever the target state turns out to be

STAGE 3 · Platform work

scoped after the findings

- Refactor or migration executed in scoped waves
- Each wave carries its own acceptance criteria
- Old and new run in parallel only for a stated period
- Decommissioning dates set at the start

RULE — Only if the assessment shows the platform itself is the constraint

STAGE 4 · Re-assessment

6 – 12 months after

- Same dimensions, same weights, same metric definitions
- Movement measured against the retained baseline
- Target levels revisited against current business need
- Remaining gaps re-sequenced

RULE — The method starts producing a trend only here

Stage 2 is the one most often skipped, because Stage 3 is the one with a product attached to it. Ownership, lineage and quality gaps migrate with the data and arrive on a new platform with migration risk added to them.

Stage 4 is what makes Stage 1 worth paying for twice. Without a re-assessment against the same definitions, there is no way to show that anything the programme did actually moved the platform.

The Limits of the Assessment and the Language Used

KOMTAS

Writing down what was not examined protects the value of what was. A reader who cannot see the boundary will assume there is none.

OUT OF SCOPE — STATED IN EVERY REPORT

Code and transformation logic review	Transformation correctness is not line-by-line verified; modelling approach is assessed, not every rule.
Data content and business correctness	Whether a figure is right in business terms is not in scope; whether it reconciles to source is.
Penetration testing	No active security testing is performed; configuration and review records are examined.
Vendor or licence negotiation	Contract terms and pricing positions are outside the assessment.
Full catalogue coverage	Lineage and ownership are assessed on the critical list, not across the whole estate.
Capacity sizing for a target platform	Sizing a replacement is a separate exercise with its own assumptions and inputs.

A good result in the assessed dimensions is not assurance for these areas.

THREE-STATE EVIDENCE SCALE

Evidence provided

A measurement, artefact or observation supports the stated level.

Partial evidence

Part of the evidence exists; the remainder was out of scope or could not be obtained.

Evidence not produced

The evidence could not be produced in the window. It does not mean the capability is absent.

Phrase not used: “the platform is non-compliant”. That is a judgement this engagement is not scoped to make.

HOW FINDINGS ARE WORDED

Language used

“The evidence for this control was not produced in this environment” rather than “this control does not exist”. The two are different claims and only one is supported.

Why it matters

An assessment is read by people who were not in the room. A sentence that overstates what was seen will be quoted back when it turns out to be wrong.

Confidence is stated

Where the measurement set was thin — short retention, no tagging, restricted access — the dimension carries a stated confidence level alongside its placement.

Comparability is the point

Same dimensions, same weights, same definitions, same evidence rules. Anything that changes between assessments is listed on the first page.

The assessment produces evidence for a decision. It does not certify the platform, it does not clear it against any standard, and it does not transfer responsibility for the decision away from the organisation that makes it.